Lane was fifteen minutes down the road from home. Much as Dad might have dreamed about me playing for United, he put that to one side when we sat down to talk. It wasn't: this is what you should do. But: what do you want to do? We decided we should at least find out what Spurs had to say.

Maybe I knew all along that it had to be United. The meeting between me, my dad and Terry Venables, who'd come back from Spain and was then managing Spurs, left me feeling like I had more questions than answers. John Moncur took us along to Terry's office. I can picture the scene now: Terry had dropped something on the floor, either some crisps or peanuts, and was bent down in his chair, scrabbling on the carpet, trying to pick them up. He looked up at us:

'So, John, what have you got to tell me about this young lad?'

Never mind not remembering me from Barcelona: that must have seemed like ages ago. I got the impression that, although I'd been training at Spurs for a couple of years, the manager didn't really have any idea who I was. I couldn't help thinking about the times I'd been up to Manchester. Alex Ferguson knew all about me. He knew all about every single boy. He knew their parents, he knew their brothers and sisters. That seemed important to me, important for my future. It always felt like you were part of a family at United.

Spurs made us a really generous offer, which amounted to a six-year deal: two years as a schoolboy followed by two years as a Youth Training Scheme trainee and then two years as a professional. A thought flashed through my mind. *By the time I'm eighteen, I could be driving a Porsche.*

'So, David, would you like to sign for Tottenham?' Terry said eventually.

Dad looked at me. He'd never been one to make my decisions for me. I took a breath:

'I'd like to think about it, Mr Venables.'

In my head, though, I was shouting out: *United! It's got to be United!*

Of course, Mum and Dad and I talked about what we'd heard. I think Mum would have liked me to join Tottenham, because of Grandad and because it would have meant me being able to stay at home, but she kept that to herself. Neither she nor Dad were going to put pressure on me one way or the other. We all knew that, if I ended up signing for Spurs, things would be